

grand theft auto *Vice city* IN 2026



IT HAS MORE PERSONALITY THAN MOST MODERN GAMES

By Divyanshi "Freaky_Duck" Sharma | feedback@skoar.in

I poke my head out of the gutter for one freakin' second and fate shovels s*** in my face! If you read this line out in a certain tone inside your head, you already know where it's from. For those less fortunate or suffering from selective amnesia, these words have been immortalised by Ken Rosenberg in GTA Vice City while speaking to the game's protagonist, Tommy Vercetti in the first scene of the legendary game.

The game launched back in 2002 and is enjoyed by players around the world. We will soon get a chance to visit its setting with GTA 6. But before that, I decided to replay the OG GTA Vice City on a random Sunday.

And just as the first cut scene loaded, I realised that it is a reminder of what modern open-world games are slowly forgetting- Personality (note the capital P there).

VICE CITY FEELS ALIVE

First things first, when you replay GTA Vice City in 2026 it certainly is a game from another time. The graphics seem ancient, combat has its issues, driving physics are somewhat chaotic,

some characters look like plastic blocks...you know where I'm going with this, right? But, the game is still enjoyable and none of this really matters. This is because the game has a lot of heart and personality to it.



The moment that first playable scene loads, there is colour, music, absurdity, and chaos directly at your face. Even the advertisements on the radio have more personality than some entire AAA games today.

Another thing to note is how Rockstar was clearly obsessed with the

1980s aesthetic while making the game. From Tommy's Hawaiian shirt to the soundtrack, every single thing commits to the theme. And that commitment gives the game an identity that stays with you.

WHAT IS LACKING TODAY?

Now, let's come to why modern games aren't probably having the same effect as Vice City. One of the reasons could be that they try so hard to be realistic, that they tend to forget about being memorable. Sure we have ray-tracing, path tracing, ultra realistic graphics and whatnot. That looks great when you first try it. But tell me honestly how many open-world cities from the last five years do you actually remember?

Vice City lives rent free in the heads of millions of players despite being over two decades old. Playing the game after at least 5 years, I could still tell where the Malibu Club or the North Point mall was. *

Read more on Digit.in
tinyurl.com/8dj19x